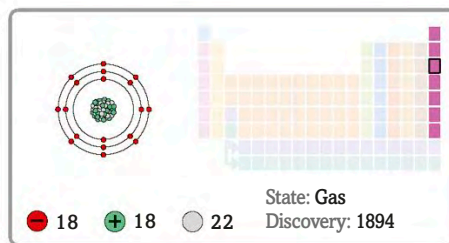
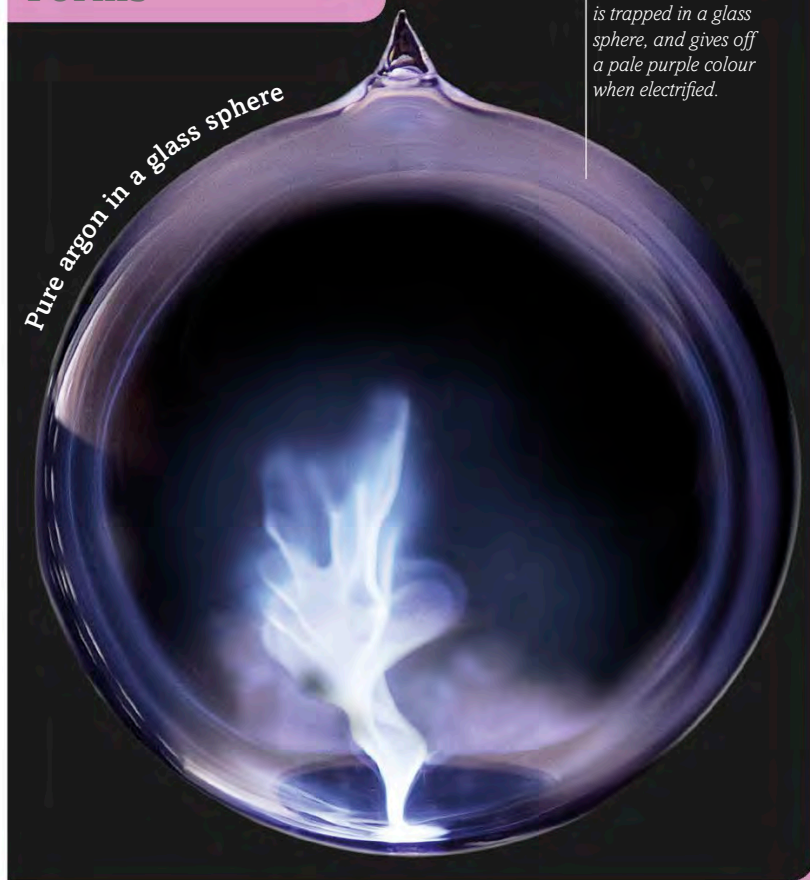


18
Ar

Argon



Forms



Uses



The Magna Carta, a historical document, is stored in argon, which forces out oxygen and water vapour that would damage the parchment.



Argon is the third most abundant gas in the atmosphere, after nitrogen and oxygen. It undergoes no reactions with any other element, and was named after the Greek word *argos*, meaning "idle". Argon does not conduct heat well so it is put in **double-glazed windows**,

and in **diving suits** during cold, deep dives. Its lack of reactivity is useful. Argon is used in **museum displays** to protect delicate exhibits. It also stops metals reacting during hot **welding**. This element can also be useful in the production of titanium.